



Grade 8 SS History

3. A Turning Point in South Africa

Learning Guide

The Mineral Revolution as a Turning Point

- The **Mineral Revolution** was a major **turning point in South African history** because it changed South Africa from an **agricultural society** into an **industrial society**.
- Before this change, many people produced their own food and lived more independently. After the Mineral Revolution, more people needed **money** to buy goods, so they went to work in **cities and mines**.
- **Gold mining** became the largest and most important part of the economy. This made the Witwatersrand very valuable and increased competition for control over the goldfields.

Defeat of the Boer Republics: 1902

- When **deep-level mining on the Witwatersrand** became very profitable, **Britain wanted control** of the **Transvaal** and the **Orange Free State** because of their goldfields.
- This led to the **Anglo-Boer War**, also called the **South African War**, which took place from **1899 to 1902**.
- The **Boers** of the Transvaal and Orange Free State fought against **Britain**. The **Cape Colony** and **Natal** supported Britain.
- Black people also participated in the war. Some supported the **Boers**, while others supported the **British**.
- Britain won the war in **1902**, gaining control of the goldfields and increasing colonial dominance in South Africa.

African Political Organisation (APO): 1902

- The **African Political Organisation (APO)** was formed in **1902**.
- It was created to defend the rights of **coloured people in the Cape**, who faced discrimination after the South African War.
- It was led by **Dr Abdurahman**.
- The APO used **non-violent protests** and appealed to the **British government** against restricting the vote to whites only.

Transvaal Indian Congress (TIC): 1903

- The **Transvaal Indian Congress (TIC)** was established by **Mahatma Gandhi** around **1903**.
- It was formed to fight against **anti-Indian laws** in the Transvaal.
- The TIC opposed discrimination against **Indian traders** and **Indian residents**.

Bambatha Rebellion: 1906

- The **Bambatha Rebellion** took place in **1906**.
- It was led by **Zulu Chief Bambatha ka Mancinza** against British colonial authority in the **Mpanza Valley, Natal**.
- The rebellion was caused by:
 - **Loss of land**
 - The introduction of a **poll tax**
- Bambatha demanded:

- The **return of land**
 - The **removal of the poll tax**
 - The rebellion was crushed, Bambatha was killed, and it became the **last black armed resistance to colonial rule**.
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Union of South Africa: 1910

- In **1910**, the **Cape**, **Natal**, **Transvaal**, and **Orange Free State** were united to form the **Union of South Africa**.
 - The Union was led by **Louis Botha** and **Jan Smuts**.
 - The government consisted of **only white people**.
 - Some **coloured and African people** with limited property and education could vote, but they were **excluded from parliament**.
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Formation of the SANNC: 1912

- The **South African Native National Congress (SANNC)** was founded in **1912**.
 - It was later renamed the **ANC**.
 - It was formed to oppose **discrimination against black South Africans** under the Union government.
 - The first president was **John Dube**.
 - In **1914**, SANNC leaders, led by Dube, went to **England** to protest against the upcoming **1913 Land Act**.
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Satyagraha Campaign: 1913–1914

- The **Satyagraha Campaign** was led by **Mahatma Gandhi**.
 - It was based on **non-violent resistance** called **Satyagraha**, meaning **resistance through truth and love**.
 - The campaign protested against **anti-Indian laws**, including:
 - Non-recognition of **Hindu and Muslim marriages**
 - The **R3 tax** on Indians
 - Restrictions on **Indian movement in the Transvaal**
 - Thousands joined the campaign and faced:
 - **Violence**
 - **Imprisonment**
 - **Brutality from authorities**
 - In **1914**, an agreement was reached:
 - The campaign would stop
 - The government would remove the **R3 tax**
 - Indian marriages would be recognised
 - Indians could move freely in the Transvaal
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The Land Act: 1913

- By **1910**, African farmers still owned land in places such as the **Transkei** and **Zululand**.
 - The **Land Act of 1913** restricted black people, who made up about **70% of the population**, to only **13% of the land**.
 - The remaining land was reserved for **white ownership**.
 - The reserves given to black South Africans were:
 - **Scattered**
 - Generally of **poor quality**
 - The Land Act became an important foundation of **racial segregation** and later **apartheid**.
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Map of Southern Africa: 1913 Compared with 1860

- By **1913**, the map of South Africa had changed greatly compared to **1860**.

- In **1860**, many **African kingdoms** were still independent, and the **Boer Republics** controlled little land.
 - The **Mineral Revolution** changed how Britain saw South Africa because it became **strategically and economically valuable**.
 - By **1902**, both **African kingdoms** and **Boer republics** had been defeated.
 - In **1910**, the **Union of South Africa** was formed and ruled by whites.
 - In **1913**, the Land Act reserved only a small portion of land for black South Africans.
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Key Takeaways

- ✓ The **Mineral Revolution** changed South Africa from farming to industrial mining.
 - ✓ Gold made South Africa valuable to Britain.
 - ✓ The **Anglo-Boer War** ended with British control over the goldfields.
 - ✓ Organisations such as the **APO**, **TIC**, and **SANNC** formed to resist discrimination.
 - ✓ The **Bambatha Rebellion** was a major armed resistance against colonial rule.
 - ✓ The **Union of South Africa** placed political power in white hands.
 - ✓ The **1913 Land Act** became a major foundation of racial segregation and apartheid.
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